



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

VOL. 8 ISSUE #7
July 2021

COMING EVENTS

Covid Permitting

July

1st	General Meeting
14th	Committee Meeting
25th	Model Park, Luddenham

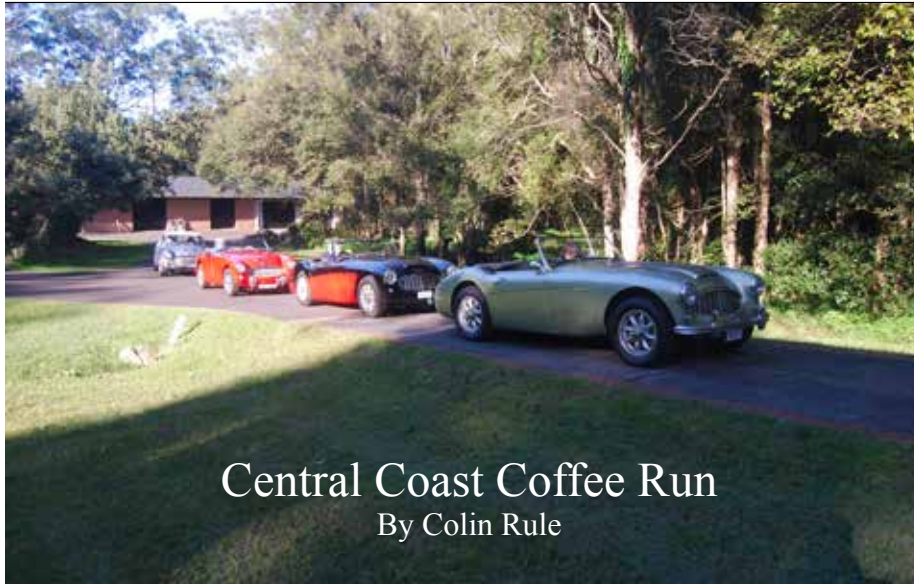
August

5th	General Meeting
7th	Central Coast Workshop
14th	Sydney Workshop
18th	Committee Meeting

See page 7 for more detail.

IN THIS ISSUE

- P1... Central Coast Coffee Run
- P2... President's Message/C'itee
- P3... Editorial
- P4... Minutes & Reports
- P10 ... South African Rally
- P13 ... A Friday Outing
- P14 Cooly Rocks On
- P15 ... Picton Conspiracy
- P17 ... What's in the Car Park
- P18 ... My other car is
- P19 Good when new!
- P20 Two out of Three
- P21 ... Trading Cards
- P22 ... Great Looking Cars
- P23 ... Photos of Interest
- P24 ... Car Rentals
- P25 Electric Austin-Healeys
- P29 ... 100 Heater Valve Stems
- P31 ... LED Headlights



Central Coast Coffee Run

By Colin Rule

Saturday 5th of June's Central Coast Austin-Healey Workshop saw a slight change as we all decided to enjoy a coffee run instead.

The morning was organised by Jenni and Ian Richter who did a sterling job choosing a fantastic venue '8 at Trinity' located on the edge of beautiful Lake Macquarie.

Being a cracker of the day we left the workshop at South Kincumber around 9.15am with seven cars travelling in convoy through back roads until picking up the second

convoy of six cars and one very nice Royal Enfield motorcycle in Sparks Road, Warnervale. When we reached our destination 81 Trinity Point Drive, Morisset Park, we had 19 participants for coffee and cake. Oh yes, there were a few pizzas consumed as well. (Hungry little Vegemites!).

Our Austin-Healeys attracted lots of attention, with many good comments from bystanders. Everyone had a great morning.

The July workshop won't happen on the first Saturday, but will be



POST: AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 6494
North Ryde NSW 2113

EMAIL: enquiries@austinhaileynsw.com.au
WEB: www.austinhaileynsw.com.au
FB: www.facebook.com/groups/681723625314952/

Normally our monthly meetings will be held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the restaurant from 5.30pm.



PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Well, the dreaded disease has struck again! Being mindful of our members' health, and not wishing to take the risk of causing further spread of Covid, your committee regretfully decided that the July General Meeting should revert to being a Zoom meeting as happened for most of 2020's meetings. I'm sorry that this has happened at such short notice, however that seems to be the nature of the beast.

Thus, the next General Meeting will begin at 7:30 on Thursday 1 July.

The link to join the meeting is <https://us02web.zoom.us/j/87258148983?pwd=K0JJVW9BTfIKZTNST-0JHY0o1STd1dz09>

Or you can open Zoom on your computer and join:
Meeting ID: 872 5814 8983
Passcode: 188272

Hopefully we will see not only regular attendees, but also some of those who cannot usually get to our meetings at Strathfield Golf Club.

Sadly, The Donald Healey Birthday Display Day, that had been planned for 4 July at Parramatta Park has also had to be cancelled. In this instance it was Parramatta Council that advised us that it was cancelling all bookings for a short period. We will arrange an alternate date a little later in the year. Not only was this to celebrate DMH's birthday, but also our annual Display Day. The highlight this year was to have had, not one, but two beautifully and very accurately restored 100s being given their final inspections for Concours d'Originalité awards. Whilst both are beautiful cars, one is a rare genuine '100M', so I'm sure will excite great interest when it is finally displayed to club members and passers-by.



Gordon Lynas – 0403 198 343 – gordonl@aussiebb.com.au

While having Concours entrants is rare, it is very re-assuring to see how the quality and originality of cars in our club has improved over the years. When our club was formed the Austin-Healey was most likely the owner's 'daily driver', and probably was some way from the pristine cars that we

Cont page 11

COMMITTEE LIST - 2021

Club Patron—Ross Bond

President - Gordon Lynas
4 Wanari Road
Terrey Hills NSW 2084
0403 198 343
gordonl@aussiebb.com.au

Vice-President - Geoff Smith
0458 777 339
m.gpsmith@bigpond.com

Secretary - Julie Lee
0421 598 755
hedli@tpg.com.au

Treasurer - John Sherman
0419 976 844
johnsher42@gmail.com

Social Secretary - Bruce Ewan
0432 096 493
bruce.ewan1@gmail.com

Editor - Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Rd.,
Kurrajong Heights 2758
(02) 4567 7380
0417 673 065
p_cquinn@tpg.com.au

Historian - Joe Armour
0419 233 099
joea6@bigpond.com

Membership Secretary - Christine Lyttle
0410 201 373
membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

Regalia - Colin Rule
0467 563 523
coolibahconvertible@bigpond.com

Technical Officer - Neville Stirton
0414 472 877
stirton@bigpond.net.au

Club Registrar - Patrick Quinn
(Inc Conditional Registration)
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's address or email at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Webmaster - Jim Phillips
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Public Officer - Alan Mitchell
PO Box 123
Marulan 2579
0412 898 656
mitchellaj@ozemail.com.au

Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ron Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Ian Clayton

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirton
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Warwick Sell, Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick Quinn, Terry Bancroft, Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 6494
North Ryde NSW 2113

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
(02) 4567 7380
0417 673 065
p_quinn@tpg.com.au

Greetings and welcome to the July 2021 issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter.

After last month's bumper issue of 35 pages, the July issue is a little smaller at 31 pages. Well that's not too much smaller, but it is endowed through the help of many members who have taken the trouble to send in words and articles. For that it's a big thanks from all of us.

As we know Covid has struck again resulting in not only the July monthly meeting now being on Zoom, but also the cancellation of the Donald Healey Birthday Display Day scheduled for July 4th. Actually DMH's birthday is the 3rd of July, so if you do happen to find a glass in your hand on that day why not raise it in appreciation.

So what's in this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter? Again it's lots and lots. Club member John Thornton has been amazingly helpful, for not only did he send in one article, he forwarded three plus a little snippet of news that he picked up on the Net. John had

recently attended the HSRCA's Sydney Classic at Sydney Motorsport Park and saw the opportunity to pen some words on what he found in the carpark, but also on coming across fellow club member John Macey who was there racing his Brabham. While not specifically Austin-Healey John also tells us about his recent experience in renting a car in Tasmania. Finally he tells us about an Austin-Healey related painting that he found online. Many thanks John for the contribution. I hope to receive many more from you.

Thank you too for the words on electric vehicles from Geoff Golding, another wonderful concoction from Ron Strange, words from John Oppenheim and Terry Bancroft plus photos from Greg Strange and news from Philip Bloom.

I will finish by saying 'Woo Hoo!'. Yes the Quinn Austin-

Healey (aka the 100 BN3/1) has finally left the confines of its cosy garage and is now with the restoration shop having its paintwork attended to. I am told that it should be three to four weeks, but that is something I am prepared to accept with more than a few grains of salt. Of course there is plenty to do while it's away such as headlight buckets, indicator/horn control head, garden furniture and so on. Then I am going to invest in a few LED panel lights shown by Philip Bloom at the June monthly meeting for the Quinn Healey garage. Lot's to do!

Trust you enjoy this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter and I look forward to receiving your photos and words on what you have been up to. Before I go I will remind everyone of the few words you will find at the bottom right hand corner on page one of every issue of Flat Chat.





Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 3 June 2021.

Commenced: 7:40pm.

Venue - Strathfield Golf Club

ATTENDEES

Refer attendance list.

VISITORS & NEW MEMBERS

There were no visitors or new members but Life Member Don Read was given a special welcome to the meeting. There was a pause in proceedings while members present made the most of being able to take lots of photos with Don! Joe Armour also took the opportunity to recognise Alan Mitchell's assistance in bringing Don to the meeting, plus Alan's assistance to the Reads in general over the past few years.

APOLOGIES

Glenn Barnes, Janice & Jeff Burton, Mal French, Garry Lee, Richard Lloyd, David Mould, Scott Parry-Jones, Rod Richards and Doug & Pamela Ross.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

Resolved that the minutes of the General Meeting held 6 May 2021, as published in the June 2021 issue of Flat Chat, be accepted as a correct record of that meeting.

Nothing to do with the minutes, but Terry Bancroft thought that Patrick had let a golden opportunity go begging in FC by not captioning the article on Terry's new car "Banger's New Banger!"

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Gordon had nothing in particular to report on.

VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

And neither did Geoff.

SECRETARY'S REPORT

Electronic magazines and newsletters received:

- Healey Torque (Qld) – May & June
- Speed Read (MSA) – May
- The Preserve (CMC) – April
- Oberon Tarana Heritage Railway – May & June
- National Motor Museum – May
- Rally Directions (CRC) – May

Other emails received:

- Membership enquiry & proof of membership enquiry (passed onto Christine)
- Invitation to East Hills Charity Car Show on 20 June at Panania, supporting Crohns & Colitis Australia (passed onto Bruce)
- Invitation from HSRCA to the Sydney Classic race meeting at Eastern Creek on 12-13 June. It will be a tribute to the late Ron Tauranac and will feature a significant collection of Brabham and Ralt cars, as well as other touring and sports cars.
- Skippy the Bus Driver (D P Carrick) trying to get hold of Gordon.
- SC Parts Group in the UK is offering discounts on parts between 5-20% off, depending on the size of the order.
- Offer from the Bundanoon Motel in the Southern Highlands with a special group rate for mid-week stays (Sunday to Thursday).
- Request from Greg Duckloe at DK Engineering in the UK for more photos of Alan Jones' 100S, as he currently had the car for sale.
- And last but not least, the opportunity to win "2 AMERICAN LEGENDS!", said legends being a RAM 1500 Express V8 (big truck-like thing) and an Indian Scout Bobber 20 (motorcycle), together valued at \$113K. Getting an insurance quote from Shannons gave you entry into the competition.

TREASURER'S REPORT

Funds as at 31 May 2021:

Debit card	\$301.93
Main Account	\$7,085.93
Cash Reserve	\$12,499.98
Charlie's Run	\$2,254.02
Term Deposit	\$78,945.63

John provided a summary of the main transactions for the month, which included payment of the Club's CSCA affiliation, windscreen purchases, bookplates and contribution to the most recent issue of the national magazine, plus payments received for three memberships and a number of the windscreens.

John also advised that Christine had been sending out membership renewals in batches. A spare Victorian Rally bag that John had went to Joe Armour. And on the subject of the Victorian Rally, Gordon advised that the Mini-Rally was now fully booked so they didn't want any further publicity.



SOCIAL SECRETARY'S REPORT

Bruce Ewan asked members to let him know ASAP if they were planning on attending the workshop at Joe Armour's, as it was coming up soon.

Bruce then went through the calendar of technical workshops and social events published in Flat Chat. He was looking for locations for the concours workshop (11 September) and also the November workshop. He also noted that the Cherry Blossom Festival was dependent on the temperature and weather, so there was no exact date as yet.

Retford Park was back on the calendar for 4 September, with the Club holding a booking for the 12:15pm tour. The ABC's Gardening Australia TV program had featured Retford Park a few weeks previously and it had looked amazing. Numbers were limited to 30 people.

Bruce noted that most events required advance planning, so it would be really helpful if members didn't leave it until the last minute to register!

Gordon advised that his "Mildura Meander" would run from 5 to 9 November. Anyone wanting to just do this run, but not the Rally would need to let him know so that he could organise hotels for their return trip.

WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

No report

WEBMASTER'S REPORT

Jim advised that the mailing list from the website hadn't quite worked out as planned for membership renewals. He asked all members to check their car(s) against the drop-down list on the website.

MEMBERSHIP

No report

EDITOR'S REPORT

Flat Chat had gone out the previous evening with no bounce-backs. Patrick reminded members that if they were interested in a high-resolution copy (which was about 25MB) to let him know.

HISTORIC VEHICLE REGISTRATION

Cars going onto Historic Vehicle Registration were

now being issued with a "J" plate, as the "H" numbers had all been used.

Patrick also clarified that those with cars on Historic Vehicle Registration were required to be a financial member of an authorised club, otherwise the registration was voided; it was not sufficient to just be a financial member at the time the registration was paid/renewed.

(JL: so make sure you renew your membership by 30 June!).

HISTORIAN

Joe regaled the meeting with some stories of the life and times of John Sprinzel, who had sadly passed away recently. Patrick had also written an article on John which was in Flat Chat.

Joe also advised that Warwick City Council in the UK (the Warwick Castle features in Austin-Healey branding) had only this year decided to recognise the impact of Donald Healey on the area. Of the three major private collections of Donald Healey documentation, one had been sold to Warwick City Council, which planned on displaying them in a local museum.

LIBRARIAN

Ron had a range of books at the meeting for members to borrow. He was also looking for homes for some Classic & Sports Car magazines.

TECHNICAL OFFICER/CLUB EQUIPMENT/ SPARE PARTS

Neville said he'd been surprised to have an issue with a loose shock absorber, but thought it was due to washers now not being as strong as they once were. He'd since used washers from a Caterpillar bulldozer radiator. They were thick and didn't bend, and although he had to grind them down a bit, he hadn't had a shock absorber come loose since. Geoff added that aircraft washers were also very good quality.

Philip Bloom demonstrated the LED panel which he'd recently purchased, and recommended. It weighed only 1.6kg, was very thin and very bright, and was good for around 60 thousand hours home use. Cost was \$54.90 plus GST, from Emerald Planet (1300 511 148).

Minutes cont'

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

Ross confirmed that it was all go for Parramatta Park on 4 July for the Donald Healey Birthday Display Day

CMC REPORT

Ray advised the most recent CMC meeting had been pretty boring so had nothing to report!

However he had a more interesting story to tell which was that some of Muriel's ancestors had been granted land at Brickfields Hill, which is where Retford House was built!

ASSOCIATION OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS

Nothing to report.

CSCA REPORT

Colin reported briefly on a couple of recent events, but more importantly, he was looking for a bonnet release spring for his Alvis! The springs were available to buy, but only in a minimum order of 100 at a cost of \$250.

Ray recalled that when he was an apprentice, they'd made springs by winding wire around a pencil!

REGALIA

To make up for being absent from the previous general meeting, Colin Rule had a bumper crop of regalia and books for sale, including:

- BJ8 brochures (1 sold to Ray Roberts)
- the last bag of trim screws (also sold to Ray)
- a heap of US books from Terry (sold to Allan Whitehouse)
- a restorer's guide – \$30

- The Story of the Big Healeys by Geoffrey Healey (sold to Julie Lee)
- workshop manuals – \$15
- a reprint 100/6-3000 manual – \$20
- 1/76 scale model cars, in gold & beige and red over black – \$15
- two uni-joints – \$40 each
- fridge magnets – 2 for \$5
- Sebring stickers for a hard top – \$15
- BMC service stickers (very important for the concours!) – 5 for \$5
- large stickers and iron on badges – \$5
- coasters – 5 left
- Cooper air cleaner stickers – \$2
- plus bags of bolts – UNF, turn buttons, door clips, Phillips screws etc.

He also reminded everyone of the coffee run on the coming Saturday. Departure would be from Chez Rule at 9:15am, with a further meeting point at 9:45am at Sparks Road, Warnervale.

FOR SALE/WANTED

Terry had a new Armacord kit from his new US car for sale at \$200, although it was worth \$340. The kit would be good for BN4, BN6, BN7 or BJ8. Terry also had some stickers for Matty's Spoked Wheels at Razorback.

GENERAL BUSINESS

Denis Kasza thanked Ray and Neville in relation to the under bonnet light from his Westminster and Joe mentioned a couple interesting articles he'd come across recently

Meeting concluded at 9.05 pm.



Don Read (front row second from left) at the June General Meeting. Photo courtesy of Alan Mitchell.

**IT'S TIME TO
RENEW YOUR
MEMBERSHIP!**

The AHOC year finishes at the end of June, meaning that membership fees are due.

New members this month:

- Damien and Shena Carrick who have relocated from the UK to Sydney and brought their 1965 BJ8 Phase 2 with them.

Welcome to you both and hopefully we will see you at a General Meeting or an event soon!

Unfortunately Covid has once again stopped us all from gathering together, and as you would know from elsewhere in Flat Chat we will be holding the General Meeting on Thursday 1 July via Zoom.

Membership renewal invoices have been sent out via the website, though not all appeared to be gone out, so they have been emailed out as well. If you did not receive your invoice please let me know so that I can

Social Report

Bruce Ewan

0432 096 493

bruce.ewan1@gmail.com

Covid permitting the following events are organised.

25 July 2021: Model Park, Luddenham
869 Luddenham Road, Luddenham NSW
<https://www.modelpark.org.au/>

August 2021: Cherry Blossom Festival, Auburn Botanic Gardens Chisholm & Chiswick Roads, Auburn, Date is dependent on the cherry blossom. Tentatively 14 August, 2021 (Subject to change. Register to be kept informed)

14 August 2021: Philip Bloom: Belrose (Improving Engines to Race Spec AND Fuel Injection). With thanks to host Philip Bloom @ 24 Wyatt Avenue, Belrose 2085. Please bring along a plate for morning tea.

4 September 2021: Retford Park, Bowral

Membership Report Christine Lyttle

0410 201 373

membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au



get it to you as soon as possible.

If you have not paid by 30 June 2021, you will not be financial!

Remember, we can only have your correct details if you advise us and update them. So please keep me advised of your changes eg phone numbers, email addresses and home address. You can make those changes yourself through the website or send your changes to the above email address.

Hope you can join us at the General Meeting on Thursday 1 July via Zoom. See Gordon's words on page 2 for the Zoom address.

Keep safe and well!

Happy Healeying
Christine Lyttle

Booking and registration in advance essential (House & Garden guided tour 3 Hours (Maximum 30 people). Meet at Partridge VC Rest Stop (at Pheasants Nest) for a beautiful scenic car journey organised and coordinated with thanks to Alan Mitchell.

11 September 2021: Patrick Quinn: Concours Workshop (Concours standards. Restoring and returning to factory spec and concours standards? Hosts are Terry and Patricia Bancroft, Llandilo.

9 October 2021: Greg Strange Workshop: (Topic to be decided). With thanks to host Greg Strange at 117 Cleveland Street, Darlington.

17 October 2021: All British Day. The Kings School, 87-129 Pennant Hills Road, North Parramatta

7 November 2021: Highfield Gardens
111 John Grant Rd, Little Hartley

Please confirm attendance for all events in advance with Bruce Ewan on 0432 096 493 or bruce.ewan1@gmail.com



Historic Vehicle Registration News

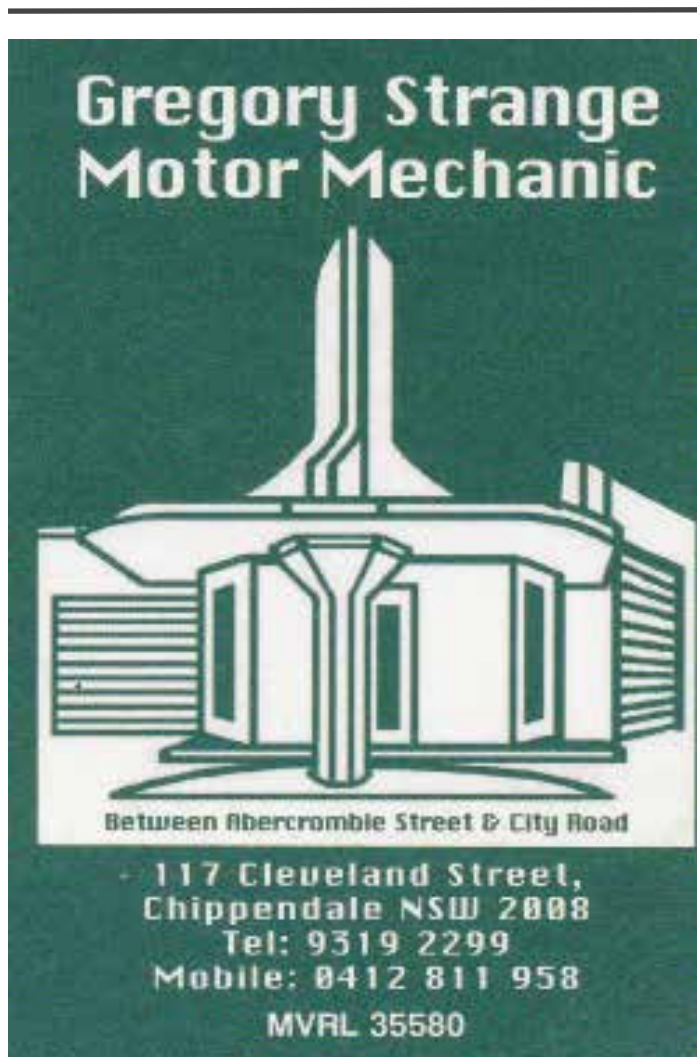
If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

It's been a month for renewals with hardly a day passing without one arriving in the letterbox, the total has increased by one to 207, which incidentally was an Austin-Healey.

It is an important time of the club year as it comes to an end on June 30th which of course means that's when memberships are renewed. As mentioned there are very few rules for Historic Vehicle Registration dictated by Transport for NSW, but one is that you "must be a member of a recognised historic vehi-

cle club". All of which means that if you let your membership lapse, your registration lapses with it. Of course you may have joined another club and changed the recorded details with Transport for NSW which is okay, but it would be good to let us know. Over the next month I will be in touch with those who have not renewed their membership and have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration to remind them of this requirement.

The calls are not going away so again find below what you need to do to renew your Historic Vehicle Registration.



**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580

- You have received the renewal documentation Transport for NSW in the post including a single sheet with "Historic Vehicle Declaration" printed at the top.
- Like other vehicles in NSW, **your historic vehicle needs to be roadworthy**. Accordingly arrange for your vehicle to be inspected at a mutually convenient time by our volunteer inspection officers (see page two of Flat Chat for their contact details) or obtain a pink slip from an Authorised Inspection Station.
- Fill in the left side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me, (**see page two of Flat Chat Newsletters for my address**) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy from the inspection officers or a copy of the pink slip. Include a stamped self-addressed envelope so I can post it all back. **This cannot be done by email as Transport for NSW only accepts original documents.**
- Once received back, you can either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post it to Transport for NSW in Parkes.

I hope that it clear enough, but of course if you don't read this you will never know.

Webmaster's Report

by Jim Phillips



The Library on our web site

Do you know that our club has a huge selection of resources for members to avail themselves of.

These consist of books, DVDs (if anyone has a machine to view them these days), magazines and VHS videos (see DVDs).

I think that I've gained a better appreciation of the material that is available since I have been updating the website with pictures and details of the books with still a lot to go, and I would encourage you to log in and have a look of what we have. You might also get an appreciation of how valuable some of these books are if you search on Google as I did.

You can see what is available by logging into the website and click on the Library tab under Members options.



Our Librarian of many years, Ron Strange, is always keen to facilitate getting these books to members, but it is not an easy job as currently the library is quite voluminous (pun intended) and in various locations between Marulan and Kincumber.

How do we resolve this?

When you see a book that you would like to borrow you may find a picture and a brief description (I'm slowly working my way through these).



However you will see if the book is available and if it has been reserved.

Unfortunately, the website does not yet include the functionality of being able for you to record your request to borrow a book and in the interim it can be done as follows:

Webmaster cont'

- To reserve a book email webmaster@austinhealeynsw.com.au and let me know the book and the best way of getting it to you.
- I will mark the book as being reserved for you which will then show up on your details on the website when you click on the Library tab so you will know that it has been noted.
- Ron will then arrange for the book to be collected from its current location and made available to get to you.
- When you return the book Ron will let me know and I'll update your details on the website.

Then comes the tricky bit - how do the books get to you.

- At a general meeting or know someone who will be and can collect it for you.
- If you are going to be attending a social event or know someone or one of the planned workshops.

Oh! And if you can have a look at other sections of the website and let me know what you would like to see I'll see what can be done.

Jim Phillips
Webmaster on Ls

Austin-Healey Club of Southern Africa – National Tour

Garden Route 28 April – 5 May 2022



The Garden Route stretches along the Southern coast of South Africa from Mossel Bay to Storms River, a distance of 250 Kms, and is approximately 30 Kms wide. The Outeniqua Mountains to the North and the Indian Ocean on the South, form natural boundaries. Knysna is roughly in the centre, however the village of Wilderness has been chosen because of its closer proximity to the two road passes that traverse the Outeniqua Mountains.

The National Austin Healey Tour of 2020 was planned to be in the Garden Route by Lionel Hewitt, but had to be cancelled because to the Covid-19 pandemic. We are recreating the original tour with a slightly longer period and a number of additions.

For more information please see <https://www.healey.co.za/>



Coffee Run cont'

on Sunday the 4th July 10am at Parramatta Park. We will all be celebrating Donald Healey's birthday as well as the Club's 'Show and Shine' and 'Concours Day'. So come along Bring your Lunch and Healeys and let's all celebrate together. Sharing a common interest and camaraderie in the Austin-Healey movement. (Unfortunately cancelled. PQ)

We welcomed three new attendees today - Patrick Townsend, Colin Goldsmith and Doug Ross, yes we had two blokes named Doug Ross.



The other attendees were. Ian and Jenni Richter BJ7, Pamela and Doug Ross, Doug Ross, Chris Jenkins, Richard Horwood, Neil Janes, Graham Adams BJ8, Colin Goldsmith 3000 Mk1, Liz and Roger Ramsay, Annie and Mark McAllan BJ8, Patrick Townshend 100, Glen Tailby BJ8, Larry Johns MK1 3000, Kerrie and yours truly Rule 100/6. We had six Austin-Healeys on the day, five town cars and one Royal Enfield.

So all take care and Happy Healeying. Col and Kerrie Rule.



President's Words Cont'

see today. My own car was not unusual as back in 1995 in being described as a '30-foot car', meaning that from 30 feet away it looked okay. The ravages of the years however became ever more apparent as one approached closer. Nevertheless, Louise and I still enjoyed travelling in the car, particularly in company with other Austin-Healeys, which of course had the added benefit that there would be someone around to help should one's beloved 100 or 3000 'fail to proceed'.

It may be my rose-tinted glasses, but it does seem that our cars not only look better, but are also more reliable that perhaps was the case 20 or more years ago. Of course, non-original modifications, such as electronic ignition, fuel pumps that have solid-state rather than electro-mechanical contact breakers, and alternators in place of dynamos has reduced the number of possible failure points, if with some small loss of originality.

Thinking back to the days of my '30 foot' car reminded me of my first AHOC General Meeting. That would

have been sometime in 1995, and I recall one member who went out of his way to make me feel welcome to the meeting. That was Don Read, and I recall having seen him extend the same friendly welcome to many another new member at meetings since then.

Sadly, Don has not been able to attend club meetings in recent years, but at our May meeting Alan Mitchell very kindly brought Don with him so that he could enjoy the evening, and we could once more enjoy his company. It was great to see him again, and hopefully he will make it to some more meetings. There were many photos taken on the night and I'm sure some will be here in this edition of Flat Chat

I wish you safe and uneventful travels in your Austin-Healey and I hope to see you in person at the August General Meeting, meanwhile please enjoy this edition of Flat Chat.

Gordon

DONALD HEALEY'S BIRTHDAY DISPLAY DAY SHOW & SHINE

CANCELLED ²⁰²¹



Please join us on Sunday 4 July 2021

At the Bowling Green, Parramatta Park

(Located near the main entry at the corner of Macquarie & Pitt Streets Parramatta)

From 10am until 3.30pm

Due to COVID we are NOT supplying lunch so please bring a picnic lunch, a chair and your car

Donald Healey was born on 3 July 1898 and throughout his lifetime was involved with the development of Healey, Austin-Healey, Riley, Travis, Triumph, Jensen, Hummer, Nash, Inland and Austin marques

Austin-Healey Owners Club (NSW) we would like to celebrate Donald's birthday with a gathering of many of the above cars as possible.

For further information, please contact Ross on 0408 465 547 or email us at

enquiries@austinhealeynsw.com.au

A Friday Outing

By Ross Penman

On Friday morning 28 May 2021 I had the pleasure of taking Bob Dorey, in honour of him turning 70, for a trip down memory lane to Brooklyn and return to Thornleigh in our BJ8.

Bob, being a lovely Welshman explained to me his affection for the Austin-Healey and how he became involved with them in the late 1960s when working for a BMC dealer. One car that he got involved with was a BN6 works car Reg. No. TON 792 driven by Nancy Mitchell in both the 1958 Alpine Rally and the Liege-Rome-Liege, even being able to drive it. Also telling me many other BMC related stories.

Even though it was a beautiful sunny morning, we didn't get the roof down as there was a very cold wind.

On our return home morning tea was served by Jenny, joined by Bob's wife Linda and daughter Joanne, looking through some Healey books and of course a photo shoot.

This wouldn't have been made possible without Bob's other daughter Kirsten who lives in Bega, who contacting our club earlier in the year. I am happy to say I couldn't remove the smile off Bob's face.



Tasmania Tour - 2022

At the request of the AHOC I have been asked to organise another Tasmania Tour in 2022.

If you wish to express your interest, please contact Terry Bancroft on 0409 323 133, or (02) 4777 4883 or bangers@bancroft.id.au

You may pull out up to around December 2021 with nil loss.

This will definitely be the last Tasmania Tour that Pat and I will be organising.

Itinerary

February 6th -	Departing Melbourne on the Spirit of Tasmania
February 7th -	Breakfast at the Edgewater Hotel Devonport
February 7th & 8th -	Overnight stay in Burnie
February 9th & 10th -	Overnight at the West Coaster Motel Queenstown
February 11th-14th -	Overnight at the Old Wool Store, Hobart
February 15th & 16th -	Overnight Bicheno
February 17th & 18th -	Overnight Casino Launceston
February 19th -	Depart Devonport for Melbourne on the Spirit of Tasmania

All mornings will include either a continental or a full breakfast depending on where we are.

Cooly Rocks On

By Terry Bancroft



Our son, Mark, had been telling Pat and me about COOLY ROCKS ON (COOLANGATTA ROCKS ON - June 9-13 2021) for months, so we flew up and joined him for the festival. Very nice too as he and his wife live in a beach side unit of the fifth floor.

Over the next couple of days we watched as from Coolangatta Beach to Greenmount Beach, Queen Elizabeth Park, was transformed with a large number of tents, trailers, dance floors selling clothing, (50's to 60's ladies clothing to memorabilia and food.) The dance floors were set up on the grass each end of the beach and live bands belted out old Rock and Roll with the dance floors were filled with eager older people strutting their stuff, fantastic.

They closed off Marine Parade and Griffith Street plus adjoining streets and Goodwin Park, for the weekend.

There were around 2000 cars of the era, parked up for a terrific display, rods, classic cars Restomods,

lead sleds, Rat Rods and a great display from the AHOC of Queensland. I even spied a six door XY GT Limo plus Cadillacs, Hudsons, Chevs, Pontiacs, Oldsmobiles, VW and a single Jensen CV8 and a Morgan. There were Fords of all descriptions and you couldn't go ten feet before you were gasping at another top vehicle, but didn't see a Rolls-Royce or Bentley all week end.

Weather was perfect; shorts and tee shirt with many of the ladies were dressed in period costume. If you couldn't Rock and Roll you could learn for free on a dance floor set up in the shopping complex.

The atmosphere was tops all week end and there would have been 30 to 40 thousand people, with everyone having a ball.

Perhaps our Social Sec, might consider a team up to the show next year. They will definitely see me up there, if they do.



The Picton Conspiracy

By Ronnie Strange

It's not my fault I was late.

Had a quick glimpse at my Omega Constellation as I arrived in Picton and surprisingly I realised I was early enough to have a wander about and maybe have a coffee before continuing onto the Joe Armour place.

While wandering about I wondered why this dress shop was open so early and asked the woman inside what the time was and she said it's ten to nine, my watch continued to deceive me, like, it's stopped.

Sprinted back to the car and realised I'm now potentially on time to arrive at nearly on time.

The water splash on the way all ended up on the windscreen and because some slag had nicked the left wiper blade I was unable to use them. I had to stop and wipe the screen.

I think that's when the Moscow people or someone in Beijing, after firstly stopping the watch, have now altered the address from 5/150 to 50/150.

Whilst driving around the estate in every direction I have now seen all the livestock and dogs, but no number 50.

With the help of those with unaffected devices we were able to find the correct place.

Once inside this secretive place there was an excellent display of Hond-Bm-Toy-van and other civilian things on the driveway and then, ultimately, the

superb cars of the Shermans and the Stranges' offerings.

After coffee and cakes we were then in the thick of it. A fine room housed fine bookcases. I flicked through two of the fourteen million magazines and books and admired hundreds of model cars, photographs, and vehicular hardware. Very spectacular.

You can't miss the fact there are two cars in this enormous room: they don't appear to have crashed through the front wall like you see on the six o'clock news every night, the only evidence of foul play or misuse around the cars is where a recent BBQ has got out of hand and scorched the bonnet of the blue car. With all that acreage outside you have to wonder! While I don't wish to be critical, had I known there was a deficiency of spark plugs (6) I would have brought some with me. Only guessing, but I reckon that's why the car won't start.

On closer inspection, the red car does have some issues (1). It needs to be backed rapidly (left corner first) into the Armco on the Mulsanne straight so the length of the left side matches the right side of the car: then the 1/2 inch or is it 33/64ths piece of silver birch packing can be removed.

More observation, not criticism, there was no wind and therefore no power generated from the well-hidden wind turbines: I suppose that would explain the dim lighting and I noticed they skimmed on the carpets (none).

Harley Boggis Photo



L-R. Ron Strange, John Sherman, Joe Armour, Judy Sherman, Greg Strange (hiding) and Bruce Ewan with '65 Sebring 3000 cont' next page

Cont from prev page

FOR SALE OR LEASE?

Then Speak to Me

For best advice and outstanding results in all aspects of selling, buying, leasing or valuing your residential/commercial property. Over 40 years experience. AHOC member for over 25 years with competitive fee structure for fellow club members.

Richard Horwood A.R.E.I.

PRINCIPAL & REGISTERED VALUER 1006

T (02) 8765 1900 **M** 0408 233 592

F (02) 8765 1922

E mail@boulevardere.com.au

boulevardere
REAL ESTATE

www.boulevardere.com.au • 2 Bennett Street Mortlake
All correspondence to PO Box 236 Concord NSW 2137

The security there is discreet but effective, as you near the display area it triggers a realistic electronic large dog bark from inside somewhere.

Outside once more for refreshments and, thanks to the key players, we were on our way again and not too soon for my liking because if and when that volcano just outside the fence erupts that place is a goner.

The drama doesn't end there. I was followed all the way to the Hume Highway from Picton by someone suspicious in a vehicle cleverly representing a police car. Once satisfied I was on neutral territory the "police" abandoned me.

Now beyond their control I was able to correctly remember my home address and headed there. The Omega Constellation remains under their control.

Flat Chat Back Issues

Interested in receiving backcopies of Flat Chat?
Now available, digital copies of Flat Chat for 2005 through to July 2021.

That's 175+ issues for you to read at your leisure.
Free and gratis to members. All you have to do is send a 1-3GB USB (thumb) drive to me at the below address along with a stamped self-address envelope.

Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Road
Kurrajong Heights
NSW 2758

You can give me the drive (& stamp) at a meeting.



What's in the Car Park?

By John Thornton

I was driving out to the HSRCA's Historic Meeting at Eastern Creek. It's a long drive from Wollongong to Eastern Creek, so lots of time to reminisce about the '70s and '80s when we all went out to Oran Park, Amaroo Park Warwick Farm, Catalina etc.

The excitement always started when you got into the carpark at these venues. The walk from the car park to your favourite viewing spot around the circuit took you past all those interesting cars of the period.

There were Minis, Coopers, Sprites, Midgets, Morgans, Jaguars, Triumphs, Sprints, hot Holdens from FJs to EHs, hot Falcons, Cortinas, Anglias with wide wheels and hot exhausts and plenty more.

So, as I walked through the car park at Eastern Creek my heart beat quickened, the excitement built, and my eyes scanned all the parked cars.

And this is what I saw:



and My Other Car is a

By John Thornton

The HSRCA held its winter Sydney Classic on 12-13 June 2021 at Sydney Motorsport Park. This year's event featured Brabham and Ralt racing cars of Ron Tauranac and Jack Brabham. The organisers achieved in attracting a great number of historic Brabham and Ralt to display and to take part in the racing program.

I was fortunate to have the Saturday free, so I headed out to see what great cars were there for the competition and display.

The beauty of these Historic events is that you can wander all through the pit area and competitors' garages, at appropriate times. Simple "etiquette" applies; don't stick your head in the door while the driver and mechanics are trying to get the car onto the circuit.

And so, as I entered one of the many garages filled with magic cars, I was pleasantly surprised to find it was occupied by AHOC member, John Macey.

John and Yonica Macey have been AHOC members for

about six years and live in the Shoalhaven region at Bombaderry. They own a blue over white Austin-Healey 100.

John has always had an interest in English Sports cars and bought his first Austin-Healey in the early '70s, a red 100/6. He spent what spare time he had over the next 14 years, working on the car with a view of restoring it.

By the time the '80s arrived and the 100/6 was still a "work in progress", there was also an increasing interest in sports cars and John started to receive phone calls expressing interest in his incomplete Big Healey, so it was inevitable that he was offered a price that convinced him to sell. The car was gone from his workshop the next day.

So, in recent years John purchased the 100 through a Shannons auction. This was a complete and running car that only requires regular attention to keep it on the road.

John says he certainly enjoys his cars.



How good when new!

by John Oppenheim

Pleased to say that I have received the BJ8 back from Platinum Smash Repairs where it had received fairly major steering and suspension work. While there it received a rebuilt steering column and box along with four refurbished lever arm shock absorbers along with some other minor remedial work, like a new clutch and brake reservoir plus some cosmetic work and a wheel alignment.

Honestly the car has been transformed. The rattle from the steering has gone, the movement of the steering wheel has reduced from about an inch in

either direction to pretty much non-existent. Handling has been improved dramatically, with no squat under braking and the whole car feeling more solid on the road. It cruises at 100 km/h with no pulling or wandering. The work compliments the Michelin XAS tyres fitted to the car and on the whole it feels more modern by about 10 years. I can't understand why anyone would consider modified the original Austin-Healey suspension, when refurbishing the original arrangements made for a dramatic improvement. I can't help but think how good the cars must have been from new.

Well spotted by John Thornton who reports that while researching some motorsport poster art he came across this Austin-Healey painting on "Historic Car Art" web site.

A beautiful lifestyle painting entitled The New Boyfriend. In this artwork an Austin-Healey 100/6 is parked besides a polo field. The girl has a new polo playing boyfriend that she is gleefully introducing to her friends... £2,250.00

A steal at that sort of money. Have a look at:-

<https://www.historiccarart.net/original-art/>




PENINSULA SPORTS CAR SERVICES

BRITISH & CLASSIC CAR SPECIALISTS

- Engine, gearbox, suspension & brake rebuilds & upgrades
- 5 speed gearbox conversions
- All servicing, tuning, repairs & restorations
- Extensive range of MG special tuning parts
- Moss master distributor for spares & upgrades
- VTO & Minator alloy wheel stockist & distributor
- Brad Penn oil stockist




VTO Wheels stocked & available in most sizes

Extensive Range of MG Special Tuning Parts

AUSTIN HEALEY & All MGs are our speciality
Brad Penn Oil Stockist

Quality Repairs & Service to all British Sports Cars at Reasonable Rates

37 WINBOURNE RD, BROOKVALE N.S.W 2100
(02) 9907 2069 • g Morse@optusnet.com.au
peninsulasportscars.com

PLATINUM SMASH REPAIRS

Specialising in Insurance and Private Work

TEL	FAX	MOB
02 9439 9552	02 9438 5671	0418 964 774



Contact: Vince Cessario AHOC Member

info@platinumsmash.com.au
13 Williams Street - Artarmon NSW 2054

Two out of Three (ain't) IS Bad. (With all respects to Meatloaf!)

By Tony Ash

I have three vehicles in my shed, the VW van (aka Healey Hilton), a Nissan 200SX and the AH 100. The van is my daily user, the Nissan is my highway GT and the concessional Austin-Healey for club and other outings.



The van is still under warranty, and serviced with VW while the other two, due their infrequent use I service every 12 months in June - change oil and filter, wheels off and brakes checked, suspension, grease points, fuel filters checked and once over (and under) car and bonnet. I completed the Nissan about two weeks ago and noted firstly only 6k miles this year (thanks COVID!) and the four road tyres were good and circa 2017. The space-saver spare (never used) circa 2002. Note to self "must replace", otherwise all good and we're giving it a 500km run to Central Coast the following week. Tick!

I started on the 100, front wheels up onto small wooden ramps (three inches) and drain the sump overnight before replacing plug, change filter and fill oil, then run up onto high ramps and jack rear for checks accordingly. Next morning I went to replace the sump plug and noted a damaged thread in the alloy (Denis Welch, finned) sump. Cleaned it and tried again with the plug. Nope! Another look (with difficulty) and gentle work I managed to remove all the threads out of the hole. Grounded! I finished up sikaflexing the bolt in, four litres of new Penrite added, drove the car out of the shed. I set up the BIG ramps, drove the car in and jacked the rear onto axle stands. Removed the sump plug and drained the oil. Next day we drove to Central Coast in the Nissan.

After two hours (110kph) down the freeway to-

wards the Central Coast in diabolical rain patches, we took the Toukley exit ramp for the 30km run to The Entrance where we were joining Canberra friends for two nights. At the first lights the engine stopped and was reluctant to start again. Only the gen light displayed so got it started (coughing and exhaust smoking) as we joined the traffic light derby to Toukley under continuous engine failures. Still raining, we sidlined into a servo forecourt and called NRMA as nothing was obviously apparent to me under the bonnet. He arrived 70 mins later, the car (now cooled) started almost normally and ran normally - no fault to fix he said, especially as there hadn't been a warning light to diagnose. He left and we left, getting to The Entrance, but engine failed to make the three floors of car park to our spot. Grounded!

Bypassing NRMA I called a friend. Not just anyone, but Geoff Smith, all round nice guy, AHOC NSW VP, Conditional rego inspector, mechanic extraordinaire and ex-QANTAS engineer. After hearing the symptoms he diagnosed fuel flooding and suspected the EFI fuel regulator and sent me looking for it (me, without tools, manual or EFI knowledge!). I found it (seeing it but not reaching it) levered (borrowed jack handle) off the vacuum tube and blocked it with a piece of two inch wide tape rolled into a cigarette and stuffed it down its 4mm throat. The left over cigarette end I bent over the vacuum tube and



Two out of three cont'



taped it on (to stop it being sucked in to the intake plenum). Test drive was perfect, but will run a little rich apparently. Back on the road now, we enjoyed our stay and then blasted up the freeway to home the next day.

I have since received a replacement fuel pressure



regulator for the Nissan and sourced and fitted a Heli-coil into the 100s sump. The next job is the upside down clean-up of the block to refit the sump and continue the annual check. (The local Brass Monkey Run for roofless sporties is on in two weeks) I have to research access into the EFI system on the Nissan somewhere in between.

Thank you to Alan Mitchell for sending these two images of some of Austin-Healey trading card collection.

Trading cards rose to prominence during the late 19th Century with tobacco companies offering them with their products. While initially the subject matters centred mostly on various sporting personalities the post-WW2 period saw motor vehicles starting to appear, including Healeys and Austin-Healeys.

Healey and Austin-Healey Trading Cards



Great Looking Cars



Thank you to Greg and Dianne Strange for sending in these three photos parked outside his garage in Chippendale.

Both cars belong to new members of our club who were having Greg undertake a little fettling. The blue BJ8 belongs to Mark Rohald of Sydney who had been looking for a suitable car for some time until he located this one in Western Australia and brought it from Sydney.

The green BJ8 belongs to Adam Blackman, also of Sydney. The car was advertised in Flat Chat a few months back for sale on the north coast.

Greg said that having the two cars parked on the forecourt of his establishment drew onlookers like bees to the honeypot. It's a busy road, but motorists would slow to a crawl for a better look and pedestrians would stop and many took photos.

Austin-Healeys were great looking cars when they were built and are still so in 2021.



Photos of Interest



An interesting photo taken on Crown Street looking east from Keira Street, Wollongong in 1956. You can see the 100 coming towards the camera.

Back then the local Austin dealer was Johnstone Brothers. Bill and Margaret Johnstone were active AHOC members through to Bill's untimely death. Margaret remains a member.

It makes you wonder if it could have been Bill driving the 100.

This 1953 Nash-Healey Roadster recently sold in a Monterey auction for US\$231,000 or the equivalent of Aus\$307,300.



Taking your Austin-Healey 100/6 and your Healey Boat (with Healey branded trailer) into the water. Hope the owner washed away the salt water.

Home mechanics tip of the month.



Covid Crazy Car Rental Rates

By John Thornton (17 June 2021)

It was great to get to a stage where the Covid lockdowns, lockouts, shutdowns and shutouts were reduced to a level where we thought it was time to venture off to Tasmania.

So, in early April, Fran and I made one of our regular trips to Tasmania to visit our son David, daughter-in-law Julie-Ann and new grandchild Molly, who we hadn't seen in about 12 months.

Being hesitant about booking a rental car too soon, due to the possibility of a lockdown somewhere in the country, I left the car booking until about a week before the trip.

Onto the net to my regular rental company. Entered all our details and nominate a four-day hire period. Best price \$1,688. What!!!!

Try a few more hire companies. All come back the same. Forget that.

Call Uber. \$173.00 for the 130-kilometer trip. He happily books me up for the return trip to the airport. Same price.

Now this week we fast forward and I book flights to Tasmania for a September visit. Onto the net once again with regular rental company and a four-day

hire period. Best price \$868. Not happy, forget booking.

I can't use Uber this time as there are four of us going, plus we need a car to visit a few other people and places.

Fran and I go out to dinner with friends that night and relayed the story to them.

"Ah! We had that problem, we didn't pre-book at all, so when we arrived at the hire counter at the airport, they have no cars for hire at all", my friend says.

"So", my friend says, "I asked the guy behind the counter about a ute".

"Yes, we can do that", replies the guy at the counter

That night, I am onto the net again with regular rental company. Quote, one dual-cab ute, four-day hire, \$422.00.

Thank you, I'll take that! Just shows a ute will always get you out of trouble.

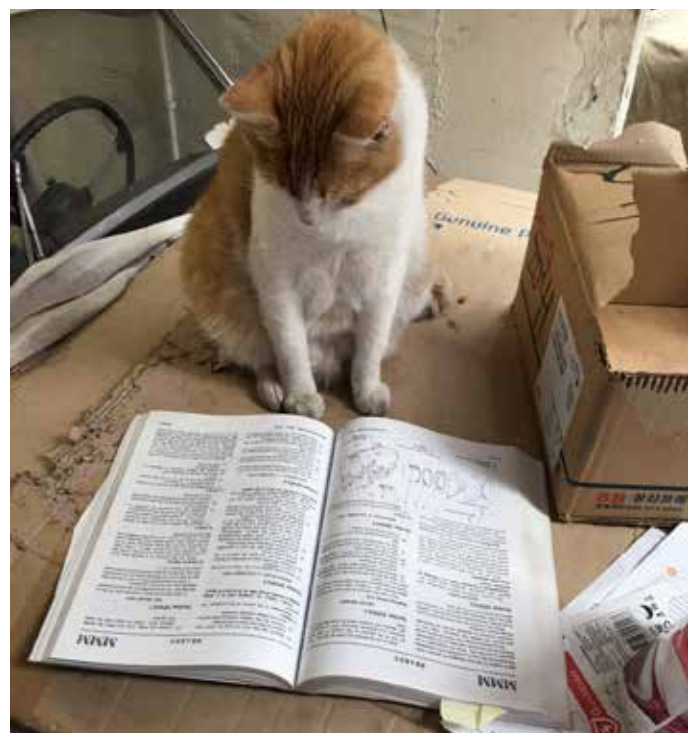
The story is that car hire firms in Tasmania sold off the bulk of their hire vehicles at the start of Covid in 2020. Now they are looking to rebuild their fleets, the manufacturers are not offering fleet discounts, so the restocking of the hire fleets is slow.

Charlie the Garage Cat studying the manual

Thank you to Dianne and Greg Strange for sending in this photo of Charlie their Garage Cat. The photo was taken by Ron Strange (no relation, well at least they don't think they are)

Normally we wouldn't be seeing a cat within Flat Chat, but we are told that Charlie is a mechanic in training. Have you noticed what he is reading?

It's page MMM.2 and 3 of the disc brake section for the 3000 Mk1 through to the BJ8 of the Austin-Healey 100/6 and 3000 Workshop Manual.



Your Electric Austin-Healey?

By Geoff Golding

Courtesy of the folks at Aussie Post and their colleagues at Kiwi Post finally, we received the Oct/Dec 2020 issue of that always interesting read, the “*Australian Austin-Healey*” magazine.

The words of our President Gordon Lynas, in this issue sparked a thought or two in the head of this Austin-Healey owner, who has a little more than a casual interest in motor cars and motoring generally.

Being an avid reader also of the British “Classic and Sports Cars” magazine as a means of getting a relatively broad spectrum of our favoured hobby and activities across the globe, I’d like to pick Gordon up on his comments regarding the future of Austin-Healeys and electric cars in general.

Initially we should all acknowledge the massive worldwide industry that fits under a general heading of “Classic Motor Vehicles” i.e. those who provide the parts – either manufacturing &/or those who retail them, the maintenance services, of course the restoration skills via places like The Healey Factory of then a fair portion of club members and I’m sure there are many more folks and businesses who maintain their classic, vintage and veteran cars... on I could go.

Initially may I suggest a very significant section of the world wide population fits into the above category either as a hobby &/or a profession e.g. car dealers, the auction houses, the restoration services and tyre suppliers, chrome platers, spray painters, upholsterers and body trimmers.

In Britain via the “Federation of British Historic Vehicle Clubs” their latest survey in indicates in Britain alone, the “Classic Car Industry” (Pre-Covid) is worth something just short of £18.3 billion annually, adding to the British Economy £9 Billion and the industry employs 113,000 people. All very significant figures in anyone’s language!

A “stray” piece of information I have read, the accuracy is dubious, but interesting - there are three million classic cars on the roads in the UK and the estimated value is £12.6 Billion.

Unfortunately, there do not appear to be any readily available facts and figures covering Australia, but cast your mind around those parts suppliers you use ranging from Kilmartins, Healey Factory, Repco, Supercheap, the oil companies and many, many others.

In short I cannot see this industry being lost completely however; I can foresee some rationalisation via mergers and take-overs; both national and international (e.g. just consider all the firms in Britain retailing Austin-Healey parts worldwide) as we move further into the 21st Century. I cannot see them all surviving a period of rationalisation.

Looking a little closer at our favoured hobby vehicles, it’s only a matter of time before someone, somewhere “electrifies” an Austin-Healey. Best guess probably in the UK or USA; but then you could argue Austin-Healeys have escalated in value considerably in the past 15-20 years which may slow down the electrification of a BJ8 or a 100.

Back again in Britain, several makes have specialist who will electrify your classic vehicle e.g. E-type Jaguars, “original” Minis, BUT in so making this conversions; the authenticity of the vehicle is lost and it is no longer is a Classic Car”.



Electric cont'

In Britain, the Federation of "British Historic Vehicle Clubs" have ruled that classic cars that are "electricified" by an owner will not retain the status of "a Classic Vehicle" however; if the vehicle can be returned back to "original" i.e. as it left the factory new, the "Classic Status" in the vehicle is returned when the conversion back to "Factory" – in theory the value will not be lost with the "reconversion" back to factory specifications.

This raises a question of.....What's the difference between a "Barn Find" Austin-Healey being rebuilt to concours standard with a conventional engine and transmission? As I see it the "judge and jury" are still out on this question, but somewhere "down the track" the decision on what is right or "not correct" may be solved in the courts by a wealthy individual using considerable resources to overturn a decision by the Federation. "We live in interesting times!"

Climate Change

There is a lot of talk about Climate Change in all areas of the media – to the point some may say it's become propaganda in my mind and this started a search for unbiased information.

At this stage I should declare my hand in that, we need to look after our environment, but not at the very considerable expense of the population and its overall well-being, a fact governments of all political persuasions seem to overlook &/or ignored completely. That "devil" carbon dioxide is a necessity for life on earth, we breathe some of it every breath we take.

Another interesting example of the importance of carbon dioxide, is it's extensively in horticulture e.g. tomato growers will pump the gas into green houses to hasten a crop to maturity.

So looking now at our "four wheeled pride and joys" in the shed. They are very "Climate Change savvy" if you stop for a minute or two and think the issues through.

Austin-Healeys have all metal panels, little or no vinyl, other than maybe a few cable ties and possibly some rubber/vinyl hoses and maybe a few plastic switches. You may choose to argue the typical classic car engine running on petrol is very inefficient. Not so sure about that point.

Your Austin-Healey properly tuned, will return something in the area of 23 to 27 miles per gallon or maybe more (that's around 11 litres/100kms).

In the case of a "modern car" the petrol consumption will be from around 6.5 litres/100kms (our Mini Cooper S) to a V8, 4 X 4 Toyota, which will return in the order of 10-11 litres per 100kms. (These figures will vary of course on how and where the vehicle is driven).

We also have to acknowledge the power and resources in the production of our Austin-Healeys and given all those issues, they are still very "Climate Change friendly"

If you consider your typical electric vehicle e.g. Nissan Leaf, BMW, Porsche, Ford, Toyota, Holden..... etc. which all vested interests i.e. Governments of generally all political persuasions and vehicle manufacturers are so keen to push us all toward these vehicles, the picture is "far from rosy" i.e. the "Stuff the vested interests" don't talk about and neither do the vehicle manufacturer; maybe they see this as a future profit stream. Yes cynical maybe!

Let's have a bit of fun here and put our head in the lion's mouth for a paragraph or two. Some facts which are freely available if you choose to seek them - away from the "casual spectator" who accepts everything that comes out of "the box" at 6.00p.m each night and masquerades as "NEWS". For those of us who take the trouble to ask "Why" after "Why" after "Why" ...looking for facts which are unbiased they are there, to be read and listened to.



Electric cont'

So to start with, in our vehicle production line, we have the steel and plastics (incl. carbon fibre) used in the manufacture of the car bodies; but then items such as brakes and wiring are very similar to our Austin-Healeys. Of course our Austin-Healey's don't have computers with their precious metals (which have to be mined) and plastics in circuit boards, etc. However, we need to take into account also the resources used in the battery manufacture of the electric car – AND; don't forget their life is finite – about ten years I understand.

On the other hand our Austin-Healeys are edging towards 70 years old; yes even the newest BJ8, and a battery is (say) \$250 and lasts 4-8 years depending on how it's maintained. Then there's a cost to replace the batteries in the electric car, I believe "thousands of dollars" each time a replacement is required, PLUS the cost of disposal of the spent battery (applicable in both cases). Nothing serious appears to be happening here by the "vested interests", other than some vehicle manufacturers are, as I understand, will take back the "spent batteries" – at a cost, of course to the vehicle owner.

In our current "throwaway society" the electric car of today will not have the same quality in built as yesteryears conventional car. Yes even the modern car is intended to last for at the very least 100,000 kms and many go on for 500,000 kms in exceptional cases.

It appears at this stage, the electric car and its life cycle is dictated by the battery and in turn its life cycle.

This then brings to mind the maintenance of the battery in the electric car. I have not seen (not that I have looked either) at what the suggested maintenance cycle is for the battery in a Tesla, Porsche, Holden, Ford or Toyota etc.

So is it fair to draw the conclusion that our electric cars of today will be destined for the scrap man in (say) five or ten years or some shorter period (depending on use and mileage?) Remember, also the cost of today's electric vehicles will fall and become cheaper to send "the spent electric car" to the scrap man, rather than buy a new battery.

Tried recently to get an electric iron fixed or some

other domestic appliance repaired? Let's be honest it's cheaper to purchase a new item these days? Will the electric car become destined for the same thinking – I suggest the car makers will push this position upon us all, basically with profit motives to the fore.

Looking at the running costs of an electric car; these take two basic paths. A) your time, and B) the fuel.

Typically an electric car (i.e. non-hybrid) will travel something around 200 to 300 kms currently on a fully charged battery I understand (depending on the make and model.)



If you live in a suburban environment your trips will be comparatively short and hence recharges will occur generally overnight at home in the garage. However, if you park overnight in the street e.g. in Paddington, Richmond, Collingwood or Leichhardt, well there is an issue here of charging your electric car. I really cannot see in the future, hundreds of extension cords being laid out across the footpaths of inner city suburbs in Australia's cities and towns, charging electric vehicle batteries. This presumes you can get a parking spot at your gate every night, which is usually not possible.

You may think there will be charging points in service stations and other convenient points e.g. supermarkets and maybe even the local park – yes fair enough; but there are literally thousands upon thousands of cars on our roads, how long will it take to have the same convenience as the service station on the corner providing charging points as we currently

Electric cont'

have with petrol. Sorry I cannot see that happening.

On the other hand if you live “out of town” where vehicle travel is essential and over a much greater distance, the picture becomes very “murky.” Some may suggest impractical with continual stops to recharge (if you can find a vacant charging point). Then there is the time you potentially waste waiting for the battery of your electric car to charge.

City Dwellers

Now is possibly the time to consider the City Dwellers annual holiday trip to “Aunt Freida” and her home on the coast at South West Rocks, or some other holiday destination within this vast continent.

What would be a day trip in your petrol fuelled Austin-Healey, becomes a “long slog” in an electric vehicle with battery recharges of about an hour each, at around Newcastle, then Port Macquarie and finally on to South West Rocks and then the extension cord you plug into Aunt Freda’s power supply to recharge at the end of the trip.

Here I quote what a Salesman at a BMW Dealership who we become friends with while we lived in N.Z., he said to me several years ago when I asked (as a retired salesman) and I was looking at the BMW electric vehicle on display.” How are you selling Electric Cars?” was my question; His reply was succinct and accurate.” They are life-style cars”. I can fully understand this philosophy.

Remembering electric cars are not new, they were being manufactured before WW1; the problem in those days was the technology relating to the battery, its weight and size. “The more things change, the more they stay the same”

Petroleum as a fuel for vehicles will be around for some very considerable time. A fact that is often overlooked is a lot conventional plastics and the surface of our roads are made from fossil fuels i.e. petroleum by-products.

There is a second part to these thoughts on electric cars. Heavy goods carrying vehicles e.g. the trucks that carry millions of tons of freight up and down our main highways – sorry I cannot see these going completely electric for many, many, many years, possibly decades to come.

Our politicians of this day and aged seem to not think or understand that “Rail” is a very effective means of moving large quantity of goods over long distances e.g. the iron ore trains in Western Australia are a prime example of the efficiency this mode of transport provides. The coal trains to the Port of Newcastle – two prime examples.

Now and into the future for some years (probably decades) with Australia’s abundant and affordable natural gas and coal and the derivative products, our Austin-Healeys will long out live the electric cars of today.

The environment as suggested at the outset is important, but in this throwaway world in which we live, there are many alternatives to only electric cars.

Given the lessons of the last 120 years, it appears hydrogen is a suitable alternative. During WW2 there were cars running on coal with small gas generators built on to the running boards – that’s the historical side of the story.

So given my thinking on Climate Change, I am well satisfied our Austin-Healeys will be on the road for many more days/miles.



Austin-Healey 100 Heater Valve Stem Repair

by Mike Salter

The Smiths heater used in the Austin Healey 100 is controlled by a valve mounted on the engine cylinder head.



There were three versions of this valve, but all have an inherent weakness in that the stem is easily broken just below the handle when too much “enthusiasm” is used to shut off the valve.



The handle is secured to a squared section of the stem of the valve with a very fine thread brass nut.

As is to be expected spare parts for these 60+ year old valves are not available, in fact original valves are difficult to find at all however all is not lost as the stem can be repaired.



Making an entire replacement stem, which has a “floating cap” on the end, would require a lot of machining.

This is the process that I use for the repair however, be advised, that this involves a lathe and some machining skills.

I start by facing off the broken end of the stem and drilling out to 11/64” to a depth of 0.4”.



Because the jaws of my lathe are too deep to hold the stem such that the end protrudes to permit facing off I have made a special collet to hold the stem in the chuck.



The next step is to make a steel insert to fit into the hole drilled in the stem. This has a $11/64$ " diameter stem on one end which is 0.4" long stepping up to a $17/64$ " diameter section 0.200" long and then down to $3/16$ " diameter 0.250 inches long.



I have been unable to identify the original thread used for the nut on these stems, let alone purchase a die to cut it so I cut a $10/32$ thread on the insert. I then hand file the $17/64$ " diameter section down to a square to fit into the original handle. (NOTE ... Thanks to Bob Haskell who has identified the thread $3/16$ " x 40 T.P.I. is a Model Engineers thread.)



After ensuring that the $11/64$ " section of the insert will fit neatly into the drilled out stem I then carefully "tin" both the insert and the drilled hole in the stem and solder the insert into the stem.



The finished repair of the stem looks like this.



The handle can then be secured with a brass $10/32$ " nut.



In reassembling the valve I use greased hemp to replace the original packing and the valve is ready to reinstall.





A sharp eye would notice that the top of the stem is now steel rather than the original brass but, as this valve is painted engine colour on a concours car this cannot be seen.

I'm confident that this repair is at least as strong as the original brass stem but caution all 100 owners to be gentle when operating this valve as it only needs to be turned until one can feel resistance **CRANK-ING IT HARD DOWN WILL NOT SERVE ANY USEFUL PURPOSE AND CAN EASILY BREAK THE STEM.**

Fitting LED headlights to your Austin-Healey

Surely one of the greatest innovations of late when it comes to lighting must be the LED (Light Emitting Diode).

We have them throughout our home and they are efficient and economical.

I know of quite a few AHOC members who have fitted LED lights to their cars. LED sidelights and indicators are certainly a vast improvement over the original globes fitted to our cars. Although to fit them throughout, especially sidelights and indicators does require some form of electronic gadgetry such as a resistor to make them light/flash when required.

A few years back Allan Whitehouse showed me the LED dash lights he fitted to his BJ7 and the difference was startling.

Some members have fitted LEDs as headlights and have been impressed to the output.

All good? Well not quite as club member Philip Bloom has written in saying that he now understands that fitting aftermarket LED headlights is no longer permissible under NSW law.

Having fitted LED headlights to his Silverstone bodied Healey, Philip now has to revert to standard incandescent globes. Not impressed!

If you would like to read further have a look at these three links that Philip has kindly provided.

<https://roads-waterways.transport.nsw.gov.au/documents/roads/safety-rules/standards/vsi64-aftermarket-forward-facing-lamps-fitting-and-use.pdf>

<https://www.4wdingaustralia.com/4x4/are-led-and-hid-light-conversions-illegal/>

<https://www.carsguide.com.au/car-advice/car-headlights-led-vs-halogen-vs-hid-vs-xenon-vs-laser-70301>

